



Flagged, Then Funded

Validating the Horizon Register's Early-Warning Alerts Against What a Priority Actually Receives

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Background

The Horizon Register flags priorities before they harden into commitments, so units can plan around what is coming. Little is known about what actually clears the threshold: the priority's novelty, or the unit's diligence in feeding the Register.

Aims

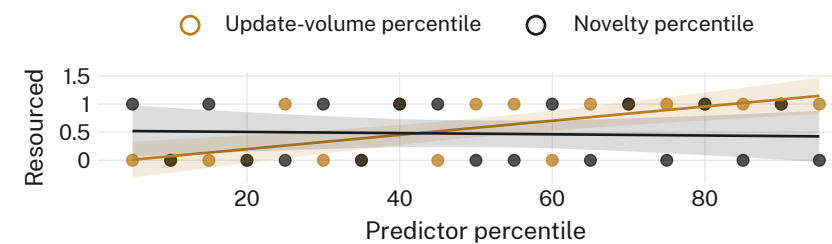
- Test whether Register alert scores predict which flagged priorities are resourced
- Compare status-update volume against novelty score as competing predictors
- Establish whether the threshold tracks the priority, or the unit's reporting habit

Methods

- 84 priorities flagged Jan 2025–Jun 2026, both Schools, drawn from the Register audit log
- Logistic regression: resourcing outcome update-volume percentile + novelty percentile
- Novelty blind-coded by an independent three-reviewer panel; thresholds held fixed throughout

Results

Update-volume percentile predicts resourcing with moderate-to-strong reliability (AUC = 0.81); novelty percentile performs little above chance (AUC = 0.58). The two measures correlate weakly ($r = 0.21$).



Across 84 priorities flagged between January 2025 and June 2026, update-volume percentile tracks resourcing outcome ($r = 0.72$); novelty percentile does not ($r = 0.19$).

Discussion & conclusions

The Register's alert threshold rewards documentation more reliably than it detects emergence. A priority that is merely well-reported clears the line as readily as one that is genuinely arriving. Next: recalibrate the threshold against a novelty-only baseline ahead of the Register's next scheduled refresh.

References

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“The best predictor of resourcing wasn't the priority. It was the paperwork.”

Update-volume percentile out-predicts novelty percentile more than three to one across 84 flagged priorities, Jan 2025–Jun 2026.